# Ershad Kunnakkadan

*Résumé*

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*Software Engineer turned CEO with deep expertise in infrastructure, security, and scalable systems. Recognized by the U.S. government as an individual with extraordinary ability (O-1A visa). Progressed from hands-on engineer to leading Gumroad as CEO, responsible for company strategy, product vision, and long-term growth. Background includes open source contributions to GitLab and Wikimedia, security research recognized by GitHub, and mentoring through Google Summer of Code.*

## Technical skills

**Languages** Ruby, Python, JavaScript, Go, Elixir, C, C++, Lua, HCL, Shell Script, HTML/CSS/Haml/SaSS, Visual Basic, Embedded programming with C

**Frameworks** Ruby on Rails, Phoenix, WebDriverIO, ReactJS, AngularJS, Qt4, Pyxmpp, python-twitter, jQuery

**DevOps** AWS, Heroku, Cloudflare, DigitalOcean, Docker, Ansible, Chef, Terraform, Nomad, Consul, Vault, Okta

**Software Packages** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, LaTeX, Adobe Photoshop, Office suites

## Work Experience and Positions

November 2025 – March 2026
**Chief Executive Officer**, *Gumroad Inc*, New York, https://gumroad.com.
Led Gumroad's overall strategy, product direction, and operations. Accountable for company performance, culture, and long term growth.

January 2025 – November 2025
**Staff Software Engineer**, *Gumroad Inc*, New York, https://gumroad.com.
Moved to New York on O-1A visa for individuals with extraordinary ability. Staff Engineer for infrastructure, security and performance.

June 2020 – December 2024
**Senior Software Engineer**, *Gumroad Inc*, Remote, https://gumroad.com.
Full-stack developer and lead engineer for infrastructure, security and performance.

July 2015 – June 2020
**Senior Software Engineer**, *BigBinary*, Remote, https://bigbinary.com.
Full-stack developer, consulted for various clients of BigBinary.

Jan 2013 – July 2015
**Software Architect**, *BangTheTable, Bangalore*, https://bangthetable.com.
Lead of one of the software engineering teams. Designed and implemented solutions for the flagship product EngagementHQ while taking care of its DevOps, scalability and security.

May 2012 – Dec 2012
**Software Engineer**, *BangTheTable, Bangalore*, https://bangthetable.com.
Contributed to the development of various software products of Bang the Table.

Mar 2012 – Apr 2012
**Developer Intern**, *BangTheTable, Bangalore*, https://bangthetable.com.
Learned and developed software for BangTheTable.

## Education

- Bachelor's degree in Computer Science from Bharathiyar University, India.

## Google Summer of Code (GSoC)

2014 **Language detection and filter in Diaspora**, *Swathanthra Malayalam Computing*.
Mentored and assessed the work of Google Summer of Code participants.

2013 **Grandham - Bibliography data project**, *Swathanthra Malayalam Computing*.
Built Grandham platform and APIs. Successfully completed the project.

## Security Bounty

- **GitHub** – https://bounty.github.com/researchers/ershad.html
  Found a security vulnerability in GitHub Gist.

- **Prezi.com** – https://prezi.com/bugbounty/whitehats
  Found a security vulnerability which exposed title of presentations in database.

## Open Source Contributions

2017 **GitLab, Inc.**, Built a feature to directly address users in description / comments., http://contributors.gitlab.com/contributors/ershad-kunnakkadan/commits.

2012 **Wikimedia**, Fixed issues related to Universal Language Selector, https://wikimedia.org.

2009 – Present **Swathanthra Malayalam Computing**, Developed and translated applications for the local community, https://smc.org.in.

## Blogs

- **BigBinary Blog** – https://blog.bigbinary.com/authors/ershad
  Wrote technical posts on Ruby on Rails and DevOps.

- **Personal Blog** – http://blog.ershadk.com

## Achievements

Nov 2012 **Hackathon**, *Wikimedia Foundation*.
Won the prize for 'The most innovative project' in Wikimedia DevCamp conducted at IIM Bangalore

Jul 2012 **Hackathon**, *Innoz technologies, Bangalore*.
Won third prize in the National Level Hackathon conducted at Innoz technologies, Bangalore

Mar 2012 **Shell Scripting Contest**, *Saintgits College of Engineering, Kottayam*.
Won first prize in the National Level Shell scripting competition conducted as a part of Nakshatra Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Shell Scripting Contest – Scriptaculous**, *TKM College of Engineering, Kollam*.
Won first prize in the National Level Shell scripting competition conducted as a part of Conjura Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Virus infiltration and healing competition – Virus Evacuation**, *College of Engineering Kallooppara, Pathanamthitta*.
Won first prize in the National Level Virus Healing Contest conducted as a part of Dhanus Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Linux administation and bash scripting competition – Linux Guru**, *College of Engineering Kallooppara, Pathanamthitta.*
Won first prize in the National Level Linux based Contest conducted as a part of Dhanus Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Ethical Hacking Contest – Haxploit**, *Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Kollam.*
Won first prize in the National Level Ethical Hacking Contest conducted as a part of Vidyut Tech fest

Feb 2012 **Developing Software Bot Contest – Botomatic**, *Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Kollam.*
Won first prize in the National Level Software Bot Developing Contest conducted as a part of Vidyut Tech fest

Oct 2011 **Shell Scripting Contest – Tux of War**, *National Institute of Technology, Calicut.*
Won first prize in the National Level Shell Scripting Contest conducted as a part of Tathva Tech fest

Sep 2011 **Shell Scripting Contest – #!/bin/bash**, *Model Engineering College, Cochin.*
Won first prize in the National Level Shell Scripting Contest conducted as a part of Excelmec Tech fest

Feb 2011 **Paper Presentation Competition: Git Verson Control System**, *Nehru College of Engineering and Research Centre,Thrissur.*
Won first prize in the Paper Presentation Competition conducted as a part of Prayaana Tech fest

## Talks and Workshops

Feb 2014 **Programming in Ruby for fun and profit**, *National Institute of Technology, Calicut.*
Led a workshop introducing ruby and its industry applications

Jan 2014 **Ruby Programming Language**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Led a workshop in programming in Ruby

Sep 2012 **Git Version Control System**, *MES College of Engineering, Kuttippuram, Malappuram.*
Led a workshop on Git Version Control System

Apr 2012 **Introduction to free software**, *MES College of Engineering, Kuttippuram, Malappuram.*
Presented a talk on free software and package management in debian

Jan 2012 **Free software and web technologies**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Presented a talk on free software and web technologies

Jan 2012 **GNU/Linux Command line tools and Shell scripting**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Led a workshop on GNU/Linux command line tools and shell scripting

Sep 2011 **Git Version Control System**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Led a workshop on Git Version Control System

Aug 2011 **Fun with programming and introduction to Free Software**, *NSS College of Engineering, Palakkad.*
Presented an introductory talk on free software and how to have fun with programming

Jul 2011 **Fun with programming and introduction to Free Software**, *MES College of Engineering, Kuttippuram, Malappuram.*
Presented an introductory talk on free software and how to have fun with programming